

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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PMP · CSM · M.Ed. · M.P.I.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 12 years of cross-functional program management experience, including 5+ years in Trust & Safety-adjacent operations — owning escalation frameworks, enforcement workflows, and compliance response programs that protect platform integrity at scale.
- Proven operator at the intersection of Policy, Product, Legal, and Safety — translating complex, rapidly shifting integrity requirements into structured cross-functional action plans, playbooks, and closed-loop improvement systems.
- Experienced managing high-risk, high-visibility events end-to-end — from pre-event readiness and partner coordination to live escalation response and post-event synthesis — with a consistent focus on reducing regrettable outcomes over time.
- Bilingual English and Mandarin with deep experience managing global programs across diverse regulatory environments, external partner relationships, and culturally complex stakeholder landscapes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox Corporation | San Mateo, CA *Feb 2023 – Present*

Platform Integrity & Compliance Operations (2025–Present)

- Serve as primary cross-functional program owner for compliance and policy integrity affecting Roblox's Top creator accounts — coordinating response across Engineering, Policy, Legal, Safety, and Moderation during rapidly shifting regulatory and enforcement cycles; participate in VP- and C-suite meetings to represent impact and align on strategic decisions.
- Built Roblox's first false-moderation protection system from the ground up — defining risk tiers, escalation workflows, enforcement playbooks, and cross-functional communication protocols across Safety, Policy, and Legal; directly reduced wrongful content takedowns that impacted platform trust and creator engagement.
- Own integrity communications during high-stakes policy events, translating complex enforcement requirements into clear, actionable guidance with speed and precision — ensuring consistent, accurate messaging reaches affected creators and internal stakeholders simultaneously.
- Drove GTM strategy and phased rollout of an IP protection product — synthesizing escalation signals and partner feedback into iterative mitigation improvements; onboarded the platform's top developer teams through structured, playbook-driven launches.
- Managed 600+ IP-related support cases in Q1, identifying systemic patterns in escalations and root causes to inform process improvements, policy refinements, and resource planning.

High-Risk Event Operations & External Partner Management (2024)

- Produced and program-managed 5 platform-wide live events each reaching 10M+ players — owning full-cycle readiness from pre-launch risk planning through live escalation response and post-event root cause analysis; managed all external vendors and contractors against strict delivery timelines.
- Synthesized real-time escalation signals and post-event data into executive reports and closed-loop improvement plans, directly shaping risk mitigation strategy for subsequent high-risk events.
- Served as central coordinator across content, engineering, policy, and external partners during live event windows — running cross-functional sprints when issues flared, ensuring decisions and owners were clearly documented in real time.

International Integrity & Community Programs (2023)

- Supported developer and creator communities across China, Japan, and Latin America with localized integrity guidance, onboarding programs, and partner communications; navigated diverse regulatory environments and culturally distinct stakeholder expectations.
- Co-designed a structured feedback system embedding community integrity signals into the global product development cycle upstream — ensuring on-the-ground escalation patterns informed policy and product decisions before, not after, they compounded.

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox China | Shenzhen, China *Mar 2021 – Feb 2023*

- Led compliance and integrity operations for the China market, translating ambiguous local regulatory requirements into structured, actionable recommendations for global Engineering and Policy teams; built cross-border escalation frameworks bridging US and China operational and legal contexts.

- Defined GTM strategy for platform launch including integrity readiness, enforcement playbooks, and post-launch risk monitoring frameworks; designed executive reporting infrastructure to track program health and surface emerging risks to Global HQ.
- Delivered high-stakes executive briefings synthesizing market performance, integrity trends, and compliance data into decision-ready narratives — influencing Global HQ investment and resource allocation decisions for the China ecosystem.
- Coordinated critical communications across US and China teams simultaneously, managing divergent regulatory environments, stakeholder expectations, and escalation timelines with precision under pressure.

Partnership Programs Lead | California State University, San Bernardino | San Bernardino, CA *Apr 2019 – Apr 2021*

- Managed a portfolio of institutional partnerships with 100% renewal rate; designed and delivered 4 end-to-end programs totaling 130+ hours with budgets exceeding \$4M USD; achieved 60% growth in year one through proactive relationship management and continuous program iteration.
- Led cross-functional strategic initiatives resulting in 23% improvement in partner engagement; coordinated complex multi-stakeholder relationships across institutional, government, and community partners.

China Programs Coordinator | Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA *Jul 2014 – Mar 2019*

- Built and managed 5 international education programs achieving 300% enrollment growth; coordinated 10+ campus departments and 20+ global partner institutions across cultures, time zones, and regulatory environments.

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

Trust & Safety & Integrity Operations: Escalation Framework Design · Enforcement Playbook Development · Compliance Response · High-Risk Event Management · External Partner Coordination

Cross-Functional Program Management: PMP (PMI) · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · Policy-to-Operations Translation · Stakeholder Alignment · Executive Communication · GTM Strategy · Process Design

Tools & Analytics: Tableau · SQL · Excel (advanced) · Jira · Confluence · Google Suite · Dashboard Design

Languages: English (native) · Mandarin Chinese (native)

EDUCATION

Master of Product Innovation — Virginia Commonwealth University *Dec 2018*

Master of Education — Adult Learning & Human Resource Development — Virginia Commonwealth University *May 2014*

Bachelor of Arts — English & International Relations — Sichuan International Studies University *Jul 2012*